NO. 3
FEBRUARY 2027

GUIDED CHILDHOOD NEWS

AGES 6 TO 11
PRINT, READ, DO

The Guided Times

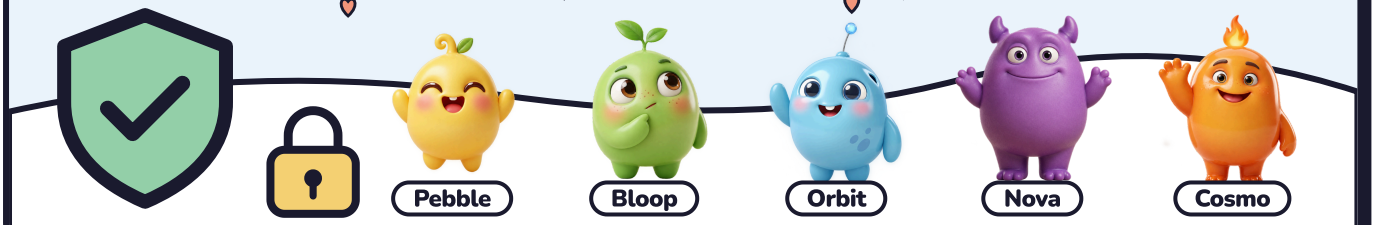
Happy news for growing up with screens

SAFER INTERNET DAY SPECIAL

Tech Check Time!

Safer Internet Day!

Safer Internet Day is on Tuesday 9 February. The Planet Friends are checking how tech makes them feel. Here is how you can too.



A tech check is easy. Think about one app, game or show you love, and ask: how do I feel while I use it, and how do I feel after? There are no wrong answers.

Turn to page 3 for the tech check, then try the kind message challenge on page 4. Grown ups, your bits have a star.

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Wow!

WOW FACT

Safer Internet Day began in 2004. Now it is marked in about 170 countries every February.

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A LETTER FROM THE EDITOR

Welcome to Issue 3, our Safer Internet Day special!



Safer Internet Day is on Tuesday 9 February, and this year it asks everyone to stop and think about how tech makes us feel. So this whole issue is a big, friendly tech check.

There is also a kind message challenge, a pancake plan (Pancake Day is the same day!), and puzzles and jokes at the back. The bits for grown ups are marked with a star.

With love, DiGi

News in brief

FROM AROUND THE PLANET



Pebble's pancake plan

Safer Internet Day and Pancake Day are on the same day this year. Pebble's family is flipping pancakes with every screen asleep.



Bloop does a tech check

Bloop noticed one game feels fun for twenty minutes and grumpy after an hour. Now Bloop stops at a save point before the grumpy bit.



Orbit makes a lantern

Lunar New Year is on 6 February. Orbit made a paper lantern for the window. There is one to try in the half term bingo.



Nova's kind messages

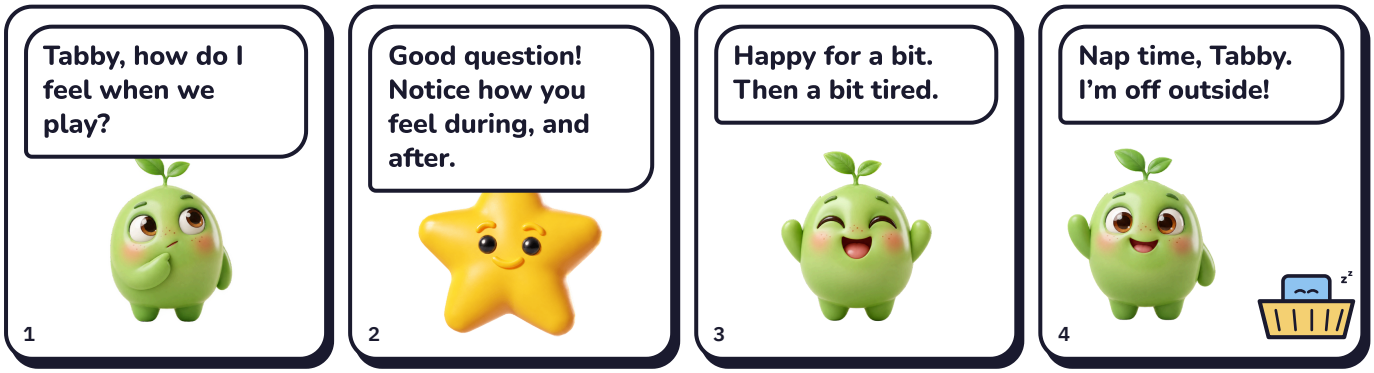
Nova sent three kind messages this week: one to a friend, one to a cousin and one to Grandma. Try it on page 4.

? DID YOU KNOW?
Pancake Day is also called Shrove Tuesday. In 2027 it is on 9 February, the same day as Safer Internet Day.

? DID YOU KNOW?
Safer Internet Day happens on the second Tuesday of February every year.

Tabby's tech check

THE COMIC STRIP, PART 3 TO BE CONTINUED



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The big feature

Your six question tech check

Pick one app, game or show you love. Then answer these six questions out loud with your grown up. There are no wrong answers.

1 How do I feel while I use it?

Happy, excited, calm, cross, bored? Say the word.

2 How do I feel after?

Notice the minute after you stop. Ready for something else, or wanting more?

3 Who do I talk to in it?

Only people I know in real life, or people I do not know?

4 Does it ask me to pay?

Coins, gems and upgrades cost real money. Always ask before you tap.

5 What would I miss?

If it was gone for a week, what would you miss, and what would you do instead?

6 What is one change?

Pick one small change, like stopping at a save point, and write it on the poster.



Pick one app or game
The one you use most

→



Ask the six questions
About ten minutes

→



Choose one change
Just one

→



Check again in a month
In March



★ FOR GROWN UPS

Ask, then listen, and try not to correct the answers. Then do your own tech check out loud, on your own phone, so it is something the whole family does rather than a test for the children.

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